

THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI & AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; JAGIRDARI CRISIS

WESTERN DECCAN: TERRAIN BECOMES → CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S → PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY → CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE → ASHTAPRADHAN: EIGHT OFFICES, NOT → CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 WESTERN DECCAN: TERRAIN BECOMES A FORT NETWORK

WESTERN DECCAN TERRAIN BECOMES A FORT NETWORK SAHYADRI RIDGE HEIGHT, NARROW PASSES AND MONSOON FRICTION MAVAL VALLEYS RECRUITS, GRAIN, LOCAL INTELLIGENCE AND SHORT MOVEMENT KONKAN COAST CREEKS, CUSTOMS, PORTS AND ACCESS TO MARITIME RIVALS

SAHYADRI RIDGE → height, narrow passes and monsoon friction

MAVAL VALLEYS → recruits, grain, local intelligence and short movement

KONKAN COAST → creeks, customs, ports and access to maritime rivals

FORT NODE → garrison + store + signal + refuge + route surveillance

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SAHYADRI RIDGE → height, narrow passes and monsoon friction
- MAVAL VALLEYS → recruits, grain, local intelligence and short movement

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- KONKAN COAST → creeks, customs, ports and access to maritime rivals
- FORT NODE → garrison + store + signal + refuge + route surveillance

DEBATE / LEGACY

- NETWORK EFFECT → inland plateau, passes and coast support one another
- LIMIT → geography enables choices; organisation converts it into power.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → geography enables choices; organisation converts it into power.

01

STAGE 01 CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S TO 1707

CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S TO 1707 TORNA, MURUMBDEV-RAJGAD AND KONDANA BUILD A POONA-MAVAL BASE POONA RAID AGRA RUPTURE TERRITORIAL RECOVERY RAIGAD CORONATION SHIVAJI DIES SAMBHAJI EXECUTED

1640s → Torna, Murumbdev-Rajgad and Kondana build a Poona-Maval base

1656 → Javli

1659 → Pratapgad

1663 → Poona raid

1664 → Surat

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1640s → Torna, Murumbdev-Rajgad and Kondana build a Poona-Maval base
- 1656 → Javli
- 1659 → Pratapgad
- 1663 → Poona raid
- 1664 → Surat

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1665 → Purandar
- 1666 → Agra rupture
- 1670 → territorial recovery
- 1674 → Raigad coronation
- 1680 → Shivaji dies

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1689 → Sambhaji executed
- Rajaram shifts resistance toward Jinji
- 1700 → Tarabai's regency
- 1707 → Aurangzeb dies with war unresolved.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1700 → Tarabai's regency | 1707 → Aurangzeb dies with war unresolved.

02

STAGE 02 PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY

PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY MUGHAL PRESSURE JAI SINGH COMBINES SIEGE, DIPLOMACY AND BIJAPUR STRATEGY PURANDAR 1665 23 FORTS CEDED, 12 RETAINED; SAMBHAJI RECEIVES MANSAB 5000 INCORPORATION TEST SERVICE AND A RETAINED BASE COEXIST UNEASILY AGRA 1666

MUGHAL PRESSURE → Jai Singh combines siege, diplomacy and Bijapur strategy

PURANDAR 1665 → 23 forts ceded, 12 retained; Sambhaji receives mansab 5000

INCORPORATION TEST → service and a retained base coexist uneasily

AGRA 1666 → rank dispute, confinement and escape destroy political trust

RECOVERY FROM 1670 → forts and initiative return; surrender was not final

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MUGHAL PRESSURE → Jai Singh combines siege, diplomacy and Bijapur strategy
- PURANDAR 1665 → 23 forts ceded, 12 retained; Sambhaji receives mansab 5000

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- INCORPORATION TEST → service and a retained base coexist uneasily
- AGRA 1666 → rank dispute, confinement and escape destroy political trust

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RECOVERY FROM 1670 → forts and initiative return; surrender was not final
- SOURCE RULE → escape is secure; basket details remain a source version.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE RULE → escape is secure; basket details remain a source version.

03

STAGE 03 CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY POWER ALREADY BUILT FORTS, REVENUE, COMMAND AND NEGOTIATED AUTHORITY RAIGAD 1674 PUBLIC CLAIM TO CHHATRAPATI SOVEREIGNTY GAGA BHATTA KSHATRIYA GENEALOGY ADDRESSES CONTESTED STATUS RITUAL EFFECT

POWER ALREADY BUILT → forts, revenue, command and negotiated authority

03

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MUGHAL PRESSURE → Jai Singh combines siege, diplomacy and Bijapur strategy
- PURANDAR 1665 → 23 forts ceded, 12 retained; Sambhaji receives mansab 5000

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- INCORPORATION TEST → service and a retained base coexist uneasily
- AGRA 1666 → rank dispute, confinement and escape destroy political trust

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RECOVERY FROM 1670 → forts and initiative return; surrender was not final
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE RULE → escape is secure; basket details remain a source version.

03

STAGE 03

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY

POWER ALREADY BUILT

FORTS, REVENUE, COMMAND AND NEGOTIATED AUTHORITY

RAIGAD 1674

PUBLIC CLAIM TO CHHATRAPATI SOVEREIGNTY

GAGA BHATTA

KSHATRIYA GENEALOGY ADDRESSES CONTESTED STATUS

RITUAL EFFECT

POWER ALREADY BUILT → forts, revenue, command and negotiated authority

RAIGAD 1674 → public claim to chhatrapati sovereignty

GAGA BHATTA → Kshatriya genealogy addresses contested status

RITUAL EFFECT → ruler stands above chiefs in a legible royal idiom

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- POWER ALREADY BUILT → forts, revenue, command and negotiated authority
- RAIGAD 1674 → public claim to chhatrapati sovereignty

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- GAGA BHATTA → Kshatriya genealogy addresses contested status
- RITUAL EFFECT → ruler stands above chiefs in a legible royal idiom

DEBATE / LEGACY

- POLITICAL EFFECT → household, territory and administration gain one centre
- LIMIT → coronation crowned state-building; it did not create capacity alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → coronation crowned state-building; it did not create capacity alone.

04

STAGE 04

ASHTAPRADHAN: EIGHT OFFICES, NOT A CABINET

EIGHT OFFICES, NOT A CABINET

GENERAL COORDINATION

RECORDS AND INTELLIGENCE

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

RELIGIOUS GRANTS AND DUTIES

CONTROL PRINCIPLE

EACH OFFICE ANSWERS TO THE RULER

NO COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY, PARLIAMENTARY CABINET OR LATER PESHWA RULE.

PESHWA → general coordination

AMATYA / MAZUMDAR → finance

SACHIV → correspondence

MANTRI / WAQIA-NAVIS → records and intelligence

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PESHWA → general coordination
- AMATYA / MAZUMDAR → finance
- SACHIV → correspondence
- MANTRI / WAQIA-NAVIS → records and intelligence

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SENAPATI / SAR-I-NAUBAT → military
- SUMANT / DABIR → external affairs
- NYAYADHISH → justice
- PANDITRAO → religious grants and duties

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CONTROL PRINCIPLE → each office answers to the ruler
- TRAP → no collective responsibility, parliamentary cabinet or later Peshwa rule.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → no collective responsibility, parliamentary cabinet or later Peshwa rule.

05

STAGE 05

CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE DISTINCT CLAIMS

CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE DISTINCT CLAIMS

ONE-QUARTER FISCAL CLAIM, OFTEN TIED TO PROTECTION AND RESTRAINT

ADDITIONAL TEN-PERCENT CLAIM IN A SUPERIOR-RIGHT IDIOM

AGENTS BARGAIN, COERCE AND OVERLAP WITH EXISTING REVENUE SYSTEMS

POLITICAL EFFECT

PAYMENT MAY ACKNOWLEDGE POWER WITHOUT SETTLED SOVEREIGNTY

LOCAL EFFECT

PAYER CAN SEEK RELIEF WHILE PARALLEL AUTHORITY BECOMES NORMAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CHAUTH → one-quarter fiscal claim, often tied to protection and restraint	COLLECTION → agents bargain, coerce and overlap with existing revenue systems	LOCAL EFFECT → payer can seek relief while parallel authority becomes normal
SARDESHMUKHI → additional ten-percent claim in a superior-right idiom	POLITICAL EFFECT → payment may acknowledge power without settled sovereignty	TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CHAUTH → one-quarter fiscal claim, often tied to protection and restraint
- SARDESHMUKHI → additional ten-percent claim in a superior-right idiom

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COLLECTION → agents bargain, coerce and overlap with existing revenue systems
- POLITICAL EFFECT → payment may acknowledge power without settled sovereignty

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LOCAL EFFECT → payer can seek relief while parallel authority becomes normal
- TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

06

STAGE 06

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA

HORSE AND EQUIPMENT ASSOCIATED WITH STATE PROVISION

MAINTAINS HIS OWN HORSE AND EQUIPMENT

GANIMI KAVA

SURPRISE + INTELLIGENCE + SUPPLY ATTACK + SELECTIVE ENGAGEMENT

FORT ANCHOR

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CHAUTH → one-quarter fiscal claim, often tied to protection and restraint

SARDESHMUKHI → additional ten-percent claim in a superior-right idiom

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CHAUTH → one-quarter fiscal claim, often tied to protection and restraint
- SARDESHMUKHI → additional ten-percent claim in a superior-right idiom

COLLECTION → agents bargain, coerce and overlap with existing revenue systems

POLITICAL EFFECT → payment may acknowledge power without settled sovereignty

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COLLECTION → agents bargain, coerce and overlap with existing revenue systems
- POLITICAL EFFECT → payment may acknowledge power without settled sovereignty

LOCAL EFFECT → payer can seek relief while parallel authority becomes normal

TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LOCAL EFFECT → payer can seek relief while parallel authority becomes normal
- TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → neither pure plunder nor automatic lawful title explains every case.

06

STAGE 06

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA

HORSE AND EQUIPMENT ASSOCIATED WITH STATE PROVISION

MAINTAINS HIS OWN HORSE AND EQUIPMENT

GANIMI KAVA

SURPRISE + INTELLIGENCE + SUPPLY ATTACK + SELECTIVE ENGAGEMENT

FORT ANCHOR

STORES, REFUGE, SIGNALS AND ROUTE CONTROL SUSTAIN MOBILITY

LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

BARGIR → horse and equipment associated with state provision

SILHEDAR → maintains his own horse and equipment

GANIMI KAVA → surprise + intelligence + supply attack + selective engagement

FORT ANCHOR → stores, refuge, signals and route control sustain mobility

LOCAL KNOWLEDGE → converts short movement into operational advantage

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- BARGIR → horse and equipment associated with state provision
- SILHEDAR → maintains his own horse and equipment

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- GANIMI KAVA → surprise + intelligence + supply attack + selective engagement
- FORT ANCHOR → stores, refuge, signals and route control sustain mobility

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LOCAL KNOWLEDGE → converts short movement into operational advantage
- LIMIT → not invincibility, a social census or modern ideological insurgency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not invincibility, a social census or modern ideological insurgency.

07

STAGE 07

COAST AND NAVY: CAPABILITY WITH SCALE LIMITS

COAST AND NAVY

CAPABILITY WITH SCALE LIMITS

CREEKS, PORTS, CUSTOMS AND SEA FORTS CONNECT WAR TO

SIDIS OF JANJIRA, PORTUGUESE AND ENGLISH SHAPE NAVAL CHOICES

KOLI, BHANDARI, MUSLIM AND OTHER SAILORS PREVENT A CLOSED

GURAB AND GALIVAT LABELS REQUIRE SOURCE AND CONTEXT

REGIONAL ESCORT, DEFENCE, RAIDING AND COASTAL COMMUNICATION

NOT AN OCEANIC BLUE-WATER NAVY OR A LICENCE TO

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KONKAN → creeks, ports, customs and sea forts connect war to commerce
- RIVALS → Sidis of Janjira, Portuguese and English shape naval choices

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- PEOPLE → Koli, Bhandari, Muslim and other sailors prevent a closed identity
- VESSELS → gurab and galivat labels require source and context

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAPABILITY → regional escort, defence, raiding and coastal communication
- LIMIT → not an oceanic blue-water navy or a licence to invent fleet numbers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not an oceanic blue-water navy or a licence to invent fleet numbers.

08

STAGE 08

RESISTANCE AFTER SHIVAJI

RESISTANCE AFTER SHIVAJI

SAMBHAJI 1680-89

LEADERSHIP UNDER PRESSURE; EXECUTION REMOVES A HEAD

MOVEMENT TO JINJI CREATES STRATEGIC DEPTH BEYOND MAHARASHTRA

STRIKE COMMUNICATIONS AND DISPERSED IMPERIAL FORCES

RAMCHANDRA PANT

ADMINISTRATION AND PATRONAGE SUSTAIN NETWORKS

TARABAI FROM 1700

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SAMBHAJI 1680-89 → leadership under pressure; execution removes a head
- RAJARAM → movement to Jinji creates strategic depth beyond Maharashtra

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SANTAJI / DHANAJI → strike communications and dispersed imperial forces
- RAMCHANDRA PANT / SHANKARAJI → administration and patronage sustain networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- TARABAI FROM 1700 → regency supplies legitimacy and political coordination
- RESULT → decapitation changes the war into a more decentralised resistance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → decapitation changes the war into a more decentralised resistance.

09

STAGE 09

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS

BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687

TERRITORY, FORTS AND NOMINAL REVENUE GAINED

BUFFER LOSS

MUGHALS NOW CONFRONT MOBILE MARATHA NETWORKS MORE DIRECTLY

NEW CLAIMANTS

ABSORBED ELITES ADD SERVICE AND JAGIR EXPECTATIONS

NEW COSTS

BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 → territory, forts and nominal revenue gained

BUFFER LOSS → Mughals now confront mobile Maratha networks more directly

NEW CLAIMANTS → absorbed elites add service and jagir expectations

NEW COSTS → garrisons, siege trains, supply, policing and collection friction

REALISATION PROBLEM → conquered jama does not guarantee usable hasil

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 → territory, forts and nominal revenue gained
- BUFFER LOSS → Mughals now confront mobile Maratha networks more directly

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- NEW CLAIMANTS → absorbed elites add service and jagir expectations
- NEW COSTS → garrisons, siege trains, supply, policing and collection friction

DEBATE / LEGACY

- REALISATION PROBLEM → conquered jama does not guarantee usable hasil
- VERDICT → annexation enlarged the map while narrowing strategic flexibility.

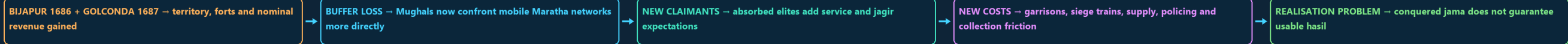
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → annexation enlarged the map while narrowing strategic flexibility.

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09

STAGE 09 ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 TERRITORY, FORTS AND NOMINAL REVENUE GAINED BUFFER LOSS MUGHALS NOW CONFRONT MOBILE MARATHA NETWORKS MORE DIRECTLY NEW CLAIMANTS ABSORBED ELITES ADD SERVICE AND JAGIR EXPECTATIONS NEW COSTS



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 → territory, forts and nominal revenue gained
- BUFFER LOSS → Mughals now confront mobile Maratha networks more directly

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- NEW CLAIMANTS → absorbed elites add service and jagir expectations
- NEW COSTS → garrisons, siege trains, supply, policing and collection friction

DEBATE / LEGACY

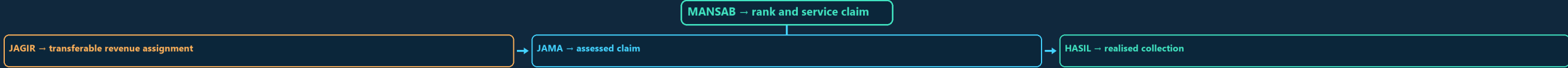
- REALISATION PROBLEM → conquered jama does not guarantee usable hasil
- VERDICT → annexation enlarged the map while narrowing strategic flexibility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → annexation enlarged the map while narrowing strategic flexibility.

10

STAGE 10 JAGIRDARI TERMS AND THE FEEDBACK LOOP

JAGIRDARI TERMS AND THE FEEDBACK LOOP RANK AND SERVICE CLAIM TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT ASSESSED CLAIM REALISED COLLECTION RESERVE ASSIGNABLE POOL SHORTAGE OF USABLE ASSIGNMENTS INFLATED JAMA



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MANSAB → rank and service claim
- JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment
- JAMA → assessed claim

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HASIL → realised collection
- PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool
- BE-JAGIRI → shortage of usable assignments

DEBATE / LEGACY

- WAR / INFLATED JAMA → weak hasil → troop and remount shortfall
- HARDER EXTRACTION → local resistance / private pacts → further disturbance
- RESULT → fiscal, agrarian, administrative and military strain reinforce one another.

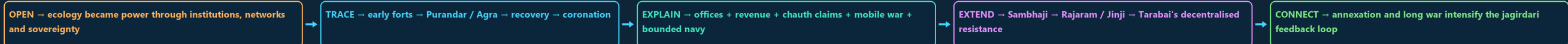
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → fiscal, agrarian, administrative and military strain reinforce one another.

11

STAGE 11 TOPIC 23 FINAL ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 23 FINAL ANSWER SPINE ECOLOGY BECAME POWER THROUGH INSTITUTIONS, NETWORKS AND SOVEREIGNTY EARLY FORTS OFFICES + REVENUE + CHAUTH CLAIMS + MOBILE WAR TARABAI'S DECENTRALISED RESISTANCE ANNEXATION AND LONG WAR INTENSIFY THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP

REJECT HERO MYTH, NATIONALISM, CABINET ANALOGY AND INSTANT COLLAPSE.



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → ecology became power through institutions, networks and sovereignty
- TRACE → early forts → Purandar / Agra → recovery → coronation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- EXPLAIN → offices + revenue + chauth claims + mobile war + bounded navy
- EXTEND → Sambhaji → Rajaram / Jinji → Tarabai's decentralised resistance

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CONNECT → annexation and long war intensify the jagirdari feedback loop
- QUALIFY → reject hero myth, nationalism, cabinet analogy and instant collapse.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → reject hero myth, nationalism, cabinet analogy and instant collapse.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK TWENTY- EIGHT SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI & AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; JAGIRDARI CRISIS — 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION 3. STUDY LINKS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-eight source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- The Marathas, Shivaji & Aurangzeb's Deccan; Jagirdari Crisis — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept — Jagirdari crisis in one line

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.